Safer school WhatsApp groups

Cyber safety · Level 1 · Lesson 4



Today we will

- Explain why photos, marks and phone numbers should never be posted in big groups.
- Design five clear rules for a class group and explain each one.
- Describe how to check an urgent request and report a strange message.

Set up a safer group

- Only admins send or edit
- Admins approve new members
- Turn on a two-step PIN
- No pupils’ photos or marks
- Call to check money requests

Our class group rules: Rule makers

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask who is in, or knows of, a family, football or faith group chat.
2. Teach (8 min): Read out the six example posts.
3. Rule makers (14 min): Groups of four write five rules for a class group: what it's for, who posts, what is never shared, how we treat each other, and what to do with a strange or urgent message.
4. Share (7 min): Each group reads its best rule.
5. Wrap-up (6 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one thing they will never post in a group and what they would do with a strange message.

Draw a large phone on the board with an empty group chat. Write six example posts on slips of paper: a class photo, a mark list, a homework reminder, a phone number, an "urgent money" message and a match result.

Let’s discuss

1. What happens in a group with no rules?
2. Could a new pupil understand each rule in one reading?
3. Which rule protects us most?

Exit ticket

- One thing I’ll never post + what I do with a strange message.